

Connect: Connects two end points together by using a segment

Fillet: Creates a rounded corner on a spline

Chamfer: Creates an angular corner on a spline

Outline: Creates an outline for the selected spline

Rendering Splines: Any spline can be rendered, either in the viewport, renderer, or both. Splines are rendered as cylindrical shapes, and rendered splines can be an easy way to model all types of objects.

Creating Geometry with Splines: The most common use of splines is as building blocks for other types of geometry. Because splines are curved shapes, they're excellent for creating smooth, organic surfaces. 3ds Max provides a number of tools to create objects by using splines.

Lathe: The Lathe modifier revolves the spline around a user-defined axis to create a surface.

Extrude: The Extrude modifier adds depth to a spline. It can be configured with caps on or off.

Sweep: Sweep uses the spline as a path to sweep a user-defined shape, which can be selected from a pull-down list.

Loft: Found under the Geometry/Compound Objects tab, Loft takes two separate splines and uses one for an extrusion, the other for the path. The shape can be further modified by using a deformation graph found under the Deformations rollout.

Surface: The Surface modifier takes a "cage" made of splines and uses it as the basis to create a smooth surface. The cage is constructed by drawing multiple splines and snapping their vertices together at the intersection points.



The lathe modifier for surfaces that can be formed by revolving the spline around an axis

2.8 Polygonal modelling

Polygonal modelling is the most common form of modelling used in 3ds Max and is one of the more-intuitive ways to model. Polygonal models are easy to construct and have no topology limitations.

The downside to polygonal surfaces is that they are not resolution independent. Low-resolution polygonal models tend to animate quickly and are used extensively in games, but their lack of detail makes them undesirable for high-resolution rendering, such as for film or video. To overcome this limitation, 3ds Max has several subdivision surface modifiers